DreamJob – Fresher Job Marketplace | Product Case Study

DreamJob

Fresher-Focused Job Discovery Marketplace Prototype

Founder & Product Owner | 2-Month Product Design Project

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1. Executive Summary

DreamJob is a marketplace prototype designed to solve structural inefficiencies in entry-level job discovery for freshers (0–2 years experience).

Existing job platforms aggregate all experience levels, resulting in:

- Experienced candidates applying to fresher roles
- Low visibility for entry-level candidates
- High application volume with low interview conversion

DreamJob proposes a niche, fresher-exclusive hiring ecosystem that improves candidate visibility and recruiter filtering efficiency.

The project was executed as a structured product design exercise over 2 months, including research, feature definition, marketplace strategy, and prototype design.

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2. Problem Definition

Core Problem

Freshers face disproportionately high competition on general job platforms due to:

- Overlapping experience-level listings
- Lack of filtering transparency
- Resume optimization challenges
- Fragmented job tracking

Impact:

- High application fatigue
- Low response rates (<5% interview callbacks in early research)
- Reduced confidence and inefficient job search cycles

Key Insight:

This is not just a discovery issue — it is a marketplace imbalance issue.

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3. User Research

Research Type

Qualitative survey of 10 freshers (0–2 years experience).

Key Findings

- Average applications per candidate: 60+
- Average interview callbacks: <5%
- 7/10 felt experienced candidates dominate fresher listings
- 8/10 preferred a fresher-only platform
- Most rely on multiple job platforms + email notifications

Limitation

Sample size is small. Further quantitative validation required for statistical confidence.

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4. Target Users

Primary Users (Supply Side)

- Final-year students
- 0–2 years experience candidates
- Internship seekers

Secondary Users (Demand Side)

- Startup recruiters hiring entry-level talent
- HR teams seeking junior-level hiring efficiency

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5. Product Vision

To build a verticalized, entry-level job marketplace that:

- Improves fairness in fresher hiring
- Reduces filtering friction for recruiters
- Increases interview conversion rates
- Centralizes job application tracking

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6. Core Hypothesis

If:

- Job listings are restricted to verified 0–2 year roles
- Candidates are ranked using skill-based scoring
- Recruiters access a fresher-exclusive candidate pool

Then:

- Recruiter filtering efficiency improves
- Candidate visibility increases
- Interview conversion rates improve

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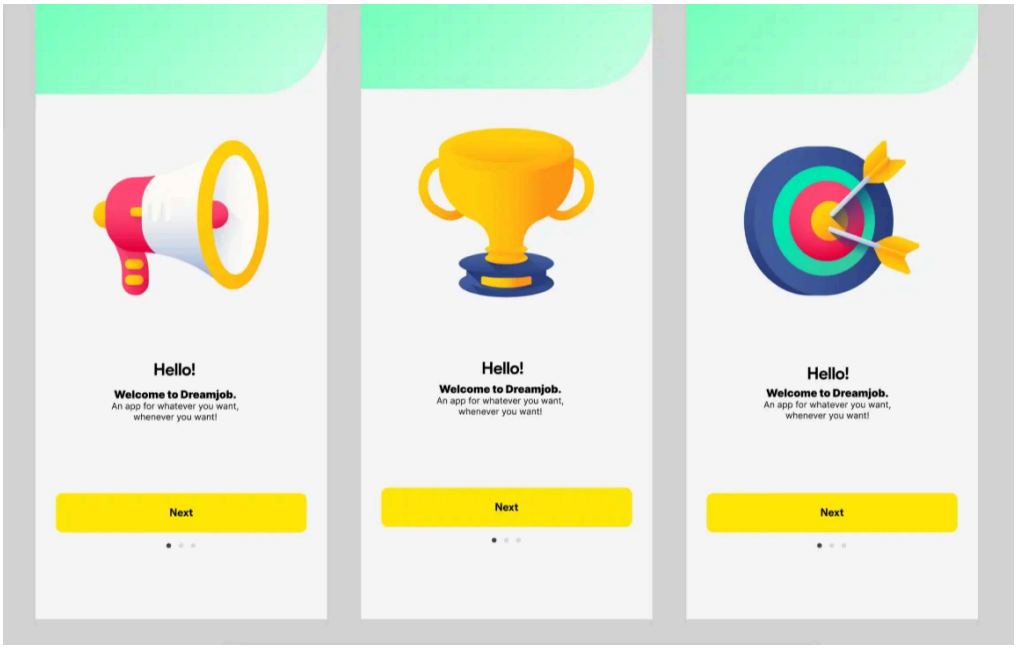
7. Product Architecture

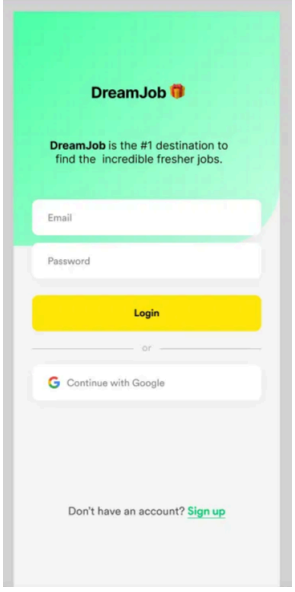
Supply Side (Freshers)

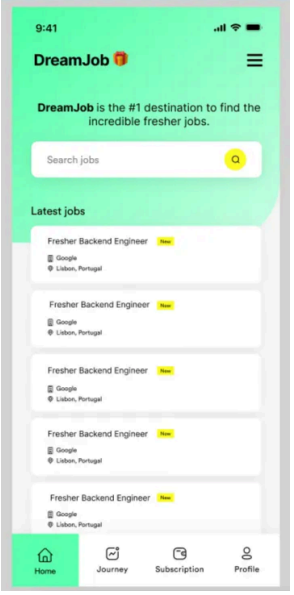
- Profile creation
- Skill tagging
- Resume upload
- Fresher score generation
- Job application tracker

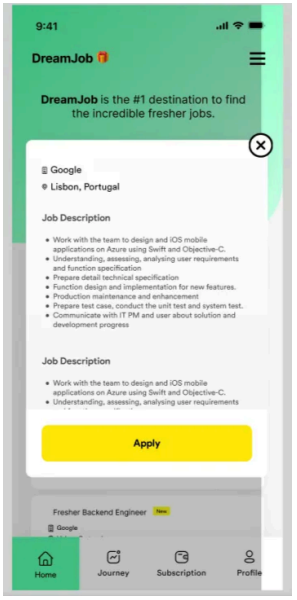
Demand Side (Recruiters)

- Fresher-exclusive candidate pool
- Score-based filtering
- In-app messaging
- Shortlisting dashboard









8. Key Features (MVP Scope)

1. Fresher-Only Job Feed
2. Skill-Based Candidate Score System
3. Smart Resume Tailoring (ATS Optimization)
4. Integrated Job Application Tracker
5. In-App Recruiter Messaging

Feature prioritization focused on marketplace fairness and visibility improvement.

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9. Competitive Landscape

Existing Platforms

- LinkedIn
- Naukri
- Indeed

Identified Gap

These platforms:

- Mix all experience levels
- Optimize for volume
- Do not isolate entry-level hiring

DreamJob differentiates by vertical focus and candidate scoring transparency.

Platform	Strength	Limitation for Freshers
LinkedIn	Large professional network & recruiter reach	Mixed experience pool; freshers compete with experienced candidates
Naukri	High job volume across industries	Limited visibility control for entry-level candidates
Indeed	Aggregated listings from multiple sources	High application competition; minimal experience filtering

10. Marketplace Risk Analysis

DreamJob operates as a two-sided marketplace.

Primary Risk: Cold Start Problem

- Without recruiters → no user value
- Without users → no recruiter incentive

Initial strategy must focus on early-stage startup hiring rather than enterprise competition.

11. North Star Metric

Interview Conversion Rate

(Interviews Received / Applications Submitted)

Reason:

Measures actual hiring impact instead of vanity engagement metrics.

12. Key Metrics

Supply Metrics

- Profile completion rate
- Resume optimization usage
- Monthly active users

Demand Metrics

- Recruiter activation rate
- Shortlist rate
- Recruiter response rate

Marketplace Health Metrics

- Application-to-interview ratio
- Time-to-shortlist
- Candidate satisfaction score

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13. Monetization Strategy

Freemium model for candidates.

Revenue primarily from recruiters:

- Pay-per-shortlist model
- Startup hiring subscription plans
- Featured candidate visibility

Reason:

Entry-level candidates have low willingness to pay; recruiters pay for efficiency.

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14. Product Development Status

Current Stage: Research & Prototype

Completed:

- User research (10 freshers)
- Marketplace strategy definition
- Feature prioritization
- North Star metric identification
- High-fidelity Figma prototype
- Pitch deck development

Not Yet Completed:

- Live MVP
- Recruiter onboarding
- Real user acquisition
- Backend development

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15. Validation Status

Current Validation Level

- Qualitative validation from early fresher sample
- Problem awareness confirmed
- Prototype feedback collected informally

Limitations

- Small sample size
- No recruiter-side interviews yet
- No action-based validation (signups / beta test)

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16. Planned Validation Roadmap

Next Steps:

1. Expand survey to 50+ freshers
2. Conduct structured interviews with 5–10 recruiters

3. Launch landing page waitlist
4. Run manual no-code beta experiment
5. Measure improvement in interview conversion

Goal: Move from opinion validation to behavior-based validation.

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17. Founder Responsibilities

As Founder & Product Owner, I was responsible for:

- Problem identification
- User research
- Hypothesis framing
- Feature prioritization
- Marketplace modeling
- Metric definition
- Prototype design (Figma)
- Product documentation

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18. Key Learnings

- Marketplace products require supply-demand balance
- Distribution is harder than feature design
- Narrow vertical focus increases clarity
- Early validation must move beyond surveys
- Honest positioning is critical in product building

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19. Future Scope

- AI-based resume scoring engine
- Candidate verification system
- Recruiter onboarding pipeline

- Basic matching algorithm
- College partnership integrations

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20. Conclusion

DreamJob is a structured marketplace design experiment addressing inefficiencies in entry-level job discovery.

While currently at prototype stage, the project demonstrates:

- Product thinking
- Marketplace awareness
- Metric-driven approach
- Realistic risk analysis

The project reflects a systematic approach to solving hiring imbalance for freshers.